

Akash Raj

Security Analyst II, Cyber Defense

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SUMMARY

Security analyst with about four years in security operations and five-plus in IT, currently the Tier III escalation point on Intact's Cyber Defense team. I run investigations from detection through containment and remediation, then write the post-incident review and fix what let the same case happen twice. Detection is the part I like most: I tune Microsoft Sentinel rules down to the ones worth acting on, and I run monthly breach and attack simulations so we find control gaps before an attacker does. Comfortable across the vulnerability management and identity side of the house as well. AZ-500, AZ-104, and CySA+ certified. Credential IDs available on request.

SKILLS

Incident Response and SOC: Tier III escalation and investigation, detection through containment and remediation, post-incident review, root cause analysis, IR playbook and SOP authoring, 24/7 shift operations and handover, MITRE ATT&CK aligned triage, tabletop exercise design and facilitation

Threat Hunting and Detection Engineering: Cyber Threat Hunting (CTH), hypothesis-driven hunting, breach and attack simulation (Cymulate), detection rule tuning, false positive reduction, sandbox and malware triage (any.run, Joe Sandbox, hybrid-analysis), threat intelligence enrichment (VirusTotal, MISP, Recorded Future, GreyNoise)

Vulnerability Management: Vulnerability assessment, Qualys VMDR, Qualys Patch Management, patch automation, emerging vulnerability triage, risk-based remediation

Identity and Access Management: Identity and Access Management (IAM), privileged access review, least privilege enforcement, access control audits, user exemption handling

Platforms and Tooling: Microsoft Sentinel (NGSIEM), Microsoft Defender for Endpoint, Microsoft Defender XDR, CrowdStrike Falcon, Rapid7, Jira, Confluence

Cloud and Infrastructure Security: Microsoft Azure (AZ-500, AZ-104), Azure security baselines, Microsoft Intune, Group Policy (GPO), Windows and Linux endpoint management

Scripting and Automation: PowerShell, Python, Shell and Bash for detection support, patch automation, and recurring security tasks

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Security Analyst II, Cyber Defense

Intact | Mississauga, ON | January 2026 - Present

Promoted from Security Analyst after 10 months.

- Tier III escalation point for complex and ambiguous incidents, taking investigations from detection through containment and remediation and writing the post-incident review.
- Retested 150+ penetration test findings and confirmed every high and critical issue was closed before it reached production.
- Run monthly Cymulate breach and attack simulations across network and endpoint, surfacing 25% more control gaps than alert-driven review.
- Tune Microsoft Sentinel (NGSIEM) detection rules, cutting false positive volume by 30% while raising fidelity on critical attack vectors.
- Triage emerging vulnerabilities at public disclosure, delivering 40+ risk reassessments within 24 hours to prioritise patching.
- Wrote and ran 5 cross-functional tabletop exercises across detection, containment, and remediation, cutting simulated MTTR by 15%.
- Wrote 12 incident response playbooks and SOPs, cutting junior analyst onboarding time by 40%.

Security Analyst, Cyber Defense

Intact | Mississauga, ON | March 2025 - December 2025

- Worked rotating 24/7 shifts on the SOC escalation ladder, triaging and containing incidents and escalating advanced cases with evidence, timeline, and impact already documented.
- Rolled out Azure security baselines across 70+ affiliates, tightening compliance posture and reducing incident risk across the organization.
- Built PowerShell and batch automation for recurring security operations work, saving 20+ hours a month.
- Managed the CrowdStrike Falcon endpoint inventory, improving visibility into stray and unmanaged assets and holding protection coverage at 99%.
- Coordinated cross-functional incident response through Jira, cutting response times by 15%.

Information Technology Security Analyst

Intact Public Entities | Cambridge, ON | June 2022 - February 2025

- Rewrote security policies into guidance people could follow, cutting unauthorized access by 75% and saving about \$20K a year in breach costs.
- Engineered patch management scripts that cut patching time by 90% and hardened the endpoints they touched.
- Ran 200+ vulnerability tests through Qualys VMDR, reducing risk exposure by 30% and remediation times by 40%.
- Built and delivered the security training programme, raising compliance by 25% and halving phishing incidents.
- Investigated and resolved security incidents in Microsoft Sentinel, consistently meeting SLA targets.
- Ran quarterly audits of privileged access, special permissions, and control groups to enforce least privilege.

Technical Support Analyst L2

Cineplex Digital Media | Waterloo, ON | April 2021 - June 2022

- Monitored the health of Linux-based digital signage networks and worked customer issues to resolution against SLA.
- Ran remote diagnostics and repairs over SSH and VNC.
- Built API integrations and scripts to automate the delivery process.
- Validated each deployment before handover to the Day 2 customer success team.

Flow Operations Clerk

Loblaw Companies Limited | Kitchener, ON | July 2019 - November 2020

Held while completing a post-graduate diploma at Conestoga College.

Web Developer

B-GHUD Academy of Information Technology | Mavelikkara, Kerala, India | July 2017 - March 2019

- Built and maintained the institution's website and web applications in JavaScript, PHP, and SQL.
- Owned the security and privacy of the institution's site and data.
- Managed the content management system and provided technical support and training to faculty and staff.

EDUCATION

- Post Graduate, Enterprise Content Management | Conestoga College, Kitchener, ON | 2019 - 2020
- B.Tech, Computer Science | University of Kerala, Kerala, India | August 2012 to March 2016

CERTIFICATIONS

- Microsoft Certified: Azure Security Engineer Associate (AZ-500)
- CompTIA CySA+ ce (CS0-003)
- Microsoft Certified: Azure Administrator Associate (AZ-104)
- Qualys Vulnerability Detection and Response (VMDR), Qualys Patch Management, Qualys CyberSecurity Asset Management (CSAM)